

FiiO M11 Hi-Res DAP

When a smartphone and a DAP (digital audio player) love each other very much, you get... the FiiO M11 Hi-Res DAP! This device evidently seems like a love child between these two pieces of technology with its Android OS and dual AK4493EQ DACs. While this DAP may resemble a smartphone in more ways than one, it still is majorly about the music. The FiiO M11 is quite a bulky and heavy DAP, which is understandable owing to the sheer number of hardware it sports internally. The M11 has a bright and sharp 5.15-inch IPS display sporting a resolution of 720p. Since it also supports Wi-Fi and has Google Chrome integrated, you can even watch videos on it. The body features a big ol' power button on the top, a pause/play button, a track seeker button and a scroll-wheel-like volume dial. The volume dial audibly clicks every time you roll it and feels extremely satisfying to the touch. The company has also loaded the M11 up on

ports which are situated at the bottom of the device. These include a traditional 3.5mm headphone jack, a 2.5mm jack and a super-narrow 4.4mm one, along with a USB-C port, used for charging, file transfer and even audio playback. Additionally, you can also connect to Bluetooth devices via Bluetooth 4.2. There's also room for not one, but two microSD cards, each capable of accepting cards up to 2TB. Albums over albums of hi-res music? No problem! Aside from external storage, the player also comes with 32GB (26GB usable) of internal storage capacity. The DAP is powered by a Samsung Exynos 7872 processor, and also comes with dual AK4493EQ DACs, as aforementioned. So, you don't



have to worry about having enough power and amplification to drive any pair of headphones on the market right now. The player supports multiple key lossless formats including aptX, aptX HS, LDAC, AAC and LHDC. It handles music extremely well, whether you are playing hi-res files, streaming from an app, playing through external storage or Bluetooth. Instruments sound warm,

vocals sound detailed and the overall experience is what you'd expect from a premium hi-res audio player, even though the DAP does put a significant dent in your pocket.

PRICE: ₹37,990

Beyerdynamic Fox USB Microphone

Aimed at podcasters, musicians and even gamers, the Beyerdynamic Fox USB Microphone is a compact and durable portable microphone that aids convenience without sacrificing audio quality. Inside the box, you get the microphone itself along with a Fox-branded pop shield which fixes around the condenser capsule, an orange, braided USB Type-C connector cable, and a desk stand with a ring mount. The microphone has a total of two inputs – a USB Type-C port on the back and a 3.5mm headphone jack in the front where you can connect a headset, which allows for zero latency monitoring. The microphone has a relatively large mute button on the front which also has an LED light to relay if the mic has been muted. Alongside this button are two knobs – one for live monitor mixing and the other for the headphone volume adjustment. The back of the microphone also has a gain controller and this can make a massive difference in how you sound. Turn this to minimum and you will barely hear yourself, turn it to max and your voice is immensely loud. We suggest finding a sweet spot somewhere in the middle. The pop shield, which we

mentioned above, fits on easily with a snap and does a commendable job avoiding plosives and fricatives (p, b; s, sh, f noises). The capsule itself is a relatively large diaphragm condenser, inside which there resides a pressure gradient transducer. Speaking of these, the audio quality is where this

Beyerdynamic microphone separates itself from the competition since it can record 24bit/96kHz audio. In contrast, many direct competitors are capable of 16bit/48kHz audio. The frequency response of the Fox microphone ranges from 20Hz - 20kHz. Having 24bit recording is quite a boon, especially during the post-production process since this makes it easy to amplify the sound if needed during editing, without dealing with excessive sound in the recording. Also, due to its cardioid polar pattern, the microphone is best at picking up what is directly in front of it which makes it great for gamers as well. The microphone is compatible with both Mac and Windows OS. This along with the portability, higher quality audio recording and live mixing ability makes the Beyerdynamic Fox USB microphone quite an appealing purchase.

PRICE: ₹14,999

